AIKIA.WALLET / BUDGET PLAN

Where the money goes, and how much.

A full budget for starting with two or three business types, and for the whole programme of 29 business types. Built for a founder with a trusted development partner. October 2026.

Rs 2.7 lakh

LEAN START: cafes only, no new build, founders sell. Year one including 15% contingency.

Rs 47.0 lakh

STANDARD: three business types, a proper product build with your partner team, 12 months. Money to put in before it carries itself.

Rs 3.00 cr

FULL PROGRAMME: all 29 business types, 24 months. Money to put in, with founders unpaid.

How to read this. Every figure is a planning estimate from published rates and stated assumptions, not a quote. Revenue lines are illustrations to show the cash need, not forecasts. The development rate for your partner company is an assumption you must replace with their real quote. Legal items are for briefing a lawyer and a CA.

What is inside

1 Assumptions and how the model works
2 The eight places money is needed
3 Lean start: cafes only
4 Standard: three business types
5 Full programme: 29 business types
6 Cost to launch each business type
7 Working with your development partner
8 What if things go slower
9 Costs people forget
10 Control, tranches, and what to cut

1 / ASSUMPTIONS

How the model works

The model adds up four things: building the product, launching it legally and safely, running the company, and selling. It then lays them over 4 quarters (Standard) or 8 quarters (Full) and compares them with an illustrative revenue line.

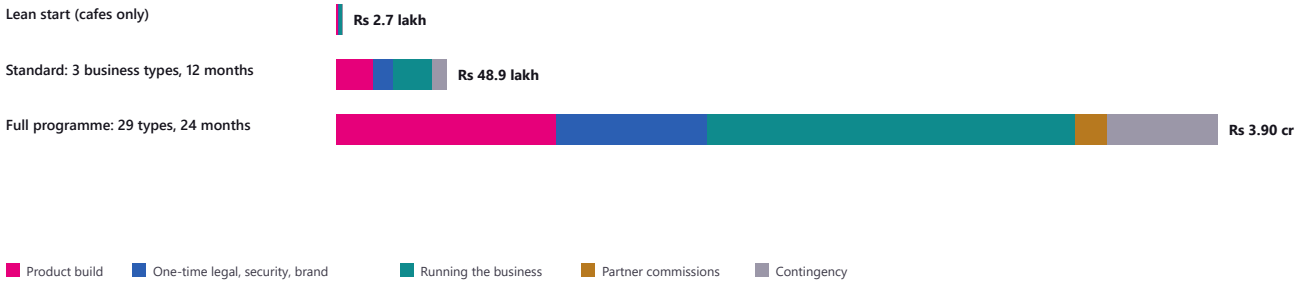
Assumption	Value used	Why, and how to change it
Development partner rate	Rs 70,000 per engineering person-month (partner), Rs 95,000 (market)	ASSUMED. Your 20-year partner may quote less or more. Replace with their real rate card.
Uplift for design, testing, project management	x1.45 on engineering cost	So a partner person-month costs Rs 1.0 lakh fully loaded (market: Rs 1.4 lakh).
Existing code already built	Core, cafe preset, Google engine, tiers, geofencing, campaigns	Only remaining work is costed. Confirm with a code review by your partner before signing.
Contingency	15%	Applied to build, one-time and running costs.
Partner and reseller commission	15% of first-year revenue	Paid only on revenue that arrives.
Dollar rate	Rs 90 per US$	Supabase, Vercel, Apple are priced in dollars.
Running-cost lines	From the Founder Playbook (pilot and growth stage tables)	Cloud, tools, communications set-up, security, legal and accounts retainer.
Illustrative venues (Standard)	3, 8, 15, 25 at quarter end; Rs 1,800 a month each	Shows the cash need; actual numbers come from the pilots.
Illustrative venues (Full)	3, 10, 25, 60, 120, 200, 300, 400; Rs 1,800 rising to Rs 3,500	Includes some chains and institutions in later quarters.
Not included	Founders' own pay; venue-funded messaging; income tax	See section 9 for founders' pay options.

The one number to get first. Ask your partner company for a written estimate in person-months for the work packages in this plan. That single quote moves the build line more than any other figure here.

2 / WHERE MONEY IS NEEDED

The eight places money is needed

Chart B1. Where the money goes



Totals include 15% contingency. Founders' own pay and venue-funded messaging are not included.

#	Bucket	What it pays for	When
1	**Product build**	Billing, rules engine, scanner upgrades, integrations, messaging, analytics, security fixes, localisation, and the modules each business type needs. Done by your partner team.	Months 1 to 6 (Standard); months 1 to 21 (Full)
2	**Legal and compliance**	Company and GST, agreements, data-processing terms, privacy notice, written view on points versus prepaid rules, trademark, higher-risk sector reviews (clinics, bars, schools, jewellers).	Before the first paying venue; more per new sector
3	**Security**	Penetration tests, cyber insurance, log archive, later ISO 27001 or SOC 2 for chains and institutions.	Before scale; yearly
4	**Cloud and tools**	Database, hosting, monitoring, support desk, design and project tools, WhatsApp and SMS accounts.	Every month
5	**People**	Support and customer success, sales, a product and operations head, part-time finance and compliance, upkeep retainer with the partner team.	From Q2 (Standard); ramps from Q3 (Full)
6	**Sales and marketing**	Demo days, printed kits, videos, local events, partner commissions.	Every month, rising
7	**Launch per business type**	A preset, sales kit, training video, pilot support and a legal check for each type you enter.	When you start each type
8	**Contingency and reserves**	15% on everything, plus the hidden items in section 9.	Held back

3 / LEAN START

Cafes only, no new build

The least you can spend to run three real cafes on the product that already exists, with you and me doing the work.

One-time

Item	Cost
Lawyer review of privacy notice, programme terms, venue agreement	Rs 25,000
Company or existing-entity paperwork, GST check with CA	Rs 10,000
QR posters, table tents, staff cheat sheets	Rs 5,000
Domain and small extras	Rs 2,000
One-time total	**Rs 42,000**

Every month

Item	Cost
Supabase Pro (about US$25)	Rs 2,250
Vercel Pro (about US$20)	Rs 1,800
Printing, small pilot gifts, travel to cafes	Rs 6,000
Monthly total	**Rs 10,050**

Optional help

Optional: one contract developer for 1 month (polish, fixes, Google card test)	Rs 70,000

Rs 2.7 lakh
year one, with the optional developer month and 15% contingency

Rs 1.9 lakh
without the optional developer month: one-time plus 12 months

0
new platform features. Uses the cafe preset, tiers, QR poster and Google card already built.

What this does not buy

- Apple Wallet, paid WhatsApp or SMS, phone-number verification (so fake numbers are possible), billing, POS integration, a penetration test or cyber insurance.
- Any support staff. You and I answer the three cafes yourselves.
- More than about 3 to 5 venues. Beyond that, support time and the missing features start to cost more than the lean budget saves.

> **Use it to answer one question:** do repeat visits go up in a cafe after 60 days? If yes, move to Standard. If not, you have spent about Rs 1.3 lakh learning that.

4 / STANDARD: THREE BUSINESS TYPES

Cafes, sweets and bakeries, salons

A proper product for these three types, built with your partner team and run for 12 months. Salons are included because they bring appointments and venue-run packs. Dropping salons saves about Rs 3.3 lakh.

Product build

Shared platform work package	Person-months	Cost at partner rate
Multi-tenant billing: plans, limits, subscriptions, GST invoices	1.2	Rs 1.2 lakh
Rules engine v2: points, stamps, expiry, tiers, offer templates	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Vertical presets and self-serve onboarding wizard	0.8	Rs 81,200
Staff scanner: offline mode, fraud and duplicate-scan controls	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Integrations: CSV + one POS (A); three POS + Shopify + booking (B wave 1)	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Apple Wallet adapter and Android / iOS parity	1.0	Rs 1.0 lakh
Messaging: WhatsApp provider, SMS with DLT, opt-in, quiet hours	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Analytics and ROI report; exports	1.0	Rs 1.0 lakh
Referral engine	0.5	Rs 50,750
DPDP toolkit: notices, consent records, access and erasure, retention	1.0	Rs 1.0 lakh
Platform console, support tools, audited impersonation	0.5	Rs 50,750
QA automation, load tests, security fixes	1.0	Rs 1.0 lakh
Localisation: Hindi, Gujarati, Marathi (A: Hindi + Gujarati)	0.5	Rs 50,750
Total shared platform work	**13.5**	**Rs 13.7 lakh**

Plus the business-type items in the next table. Total build: Rs 13.7 lakh shared + Rs 2.4 lakh for the three types = **Rs 16.1 lakh**, over about 6 months.

The three business types

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Cafes, tea and coffee shops	0.3	Rs 30,450	Rs 15,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 1.1 lakh**
Sweets, bakeries and namkeen	0.3	Rs 30,450	Rs 15,000	Rs 75,000	**Rs 1.2 lakh**
Salons, barbers, spas and nail studios	1.8	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 40,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.9 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 5.2 lakh**

Monthly running costs in this stage

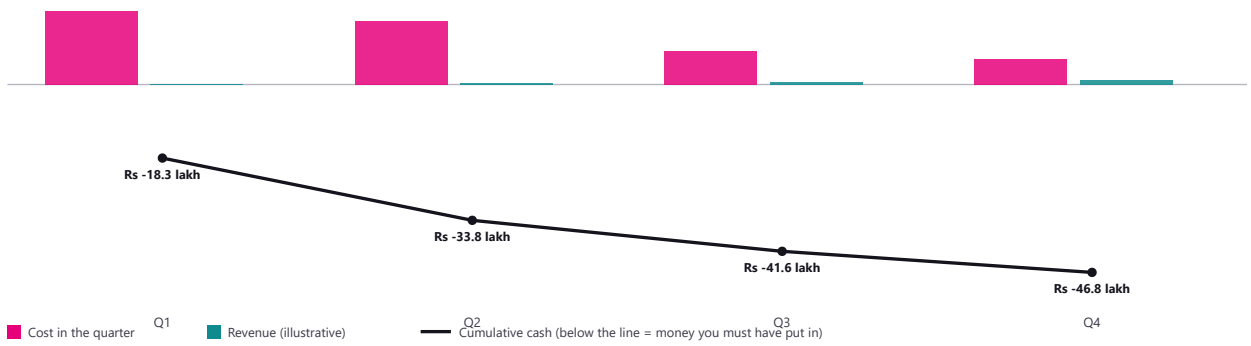
Line	Per month
Cloud, tools, communications set-up, security, legal and accounts retainer	Rs 53,000
Part-time support and customer success (from Q2)	Rs 45,000
Sales and marketing	Rs 30,000
Upkeep retainer with the partner team (from Q3, half a person-month)	Rs 50,750

One-time costs, then twelve months quarter by quarter

One-time item	Estimate
Company set-up and first compliance (incorporation, GST)	Rs 15,000
Agreements, DPA, privacy notice, programme terms (lawyer)	Rs 1,25,000
Written opinion on points vs prepaid rules and venue-run packs	Rs 1,00,000
Trademark search and filing (1 class)	Rs 30,000
DLT registration (SMS)	Rs 5,900
Apple Developer Program (first year)	Rs 8,700
Penetration test, web app + API	Rs 1,25,000
Cyber insurance, first year	Rs 80,000
Brand, pitch deck, sales kit, demo video (shared)	Rs 1,00,000
Demo devices, QR stands, printing	Rs 40,000
Per-business-type launch items (legal review, sales kit, training, pilot support, security review)	Rs 2,75,000
Total before contingency	**Rs 9,04,600**

Line	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Total
Product build (partner team)	Rs 8.1 lakh	Rs 8.1 lakh	Rs 0	Rs 0	Rs 16.1 lakh
One-time legal, security, brand, launch	Rs 5.4 lakh	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 0	Rs 9.0 lakh
Running costs (cloud, tools, people, sales, upkeep)	Rs 2.5 lakh	Rs 3.8 lakh	Rs 5.4 lakh	Rs 5.4 lakh	Rs 17.1 lakh
Partner commissions on revenue	Rs 1,215	Rs 4,455	Rs 9,315	Rs 16,200	Rs 31,185
Contingency (15%)	Rs 2.4 lakh	Rs 2.1 lakh	Rs 1.1 lakh	Rs 80,438	Rs 6.3 lakh
Total cost	**Rs 18.4 lakh**	**Rs 15.8 lakh**	**Rs 8.3 lakh**	**Rs 6.3 lakh**	**Rs 48.9 lakh**
Revenue (illustrative)	Rs 8,100	Rs 29,700	Rs 62,100	Rs 1.1 lakh	Rs 2.1 lakh
Net for the quarter	Rs -18.3 lakh	Rs -15.5 lakh	Rs -7.7 lakh	Rs -5.2 lakh	**Rs -46.8 lakh**
Cumulative cash	**Rs -18.3 lakh**	**Rs -33.8 lakh**	**Rs -41.6 lakh**	**Rs -46.8 lakh**	
Paying venues at quarter end (illustrative)	3	8	15	25	

Chart B2. Standard: cost, revenue and cumulative cash by quarter



Reading it. You need about **Rs 46.8 lakh** in hand before the plan carries itself, rounded to **Rs 47.0 lakh**. Most of it is the build and the team that supports and sells. The venues in this stage pay for only a small part of it. That is normal for a software product: the build is paid once, then sold many times.

5 / FULL PROGRAMME: 29 BUSINESS TYPES

Everything, over 24 months

All business types from the playbook, in waves, with a growing team. The shared platform work is larger because chains, institutions and enterprise buyers need more.

Shared platform build

Shared platform work package	Person-months	Cost at partner rate
Multi-tenant billing: plans, limits, subscriptions, GST invoices	2.0	Rs 2.0 lakh
Rules engine v2: points, stamps, expiry, tiers, offer templates	2.5	Rs 2.5 lakh
Vertical presets and self-serve onboarding wizard	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Staff scanner: offline mode, fraud and duplicate-scan controls	2.0	Rs 2.0 lakh
Integrations: CSV + one POS (A); three POS + Shopify + booking (B wave 1)	3.0	Rs 3.0 lakh
Integrations wave 2: further POS, ERP and booking tools	4.0	Rs 4.1 lakh
Apple Wallet adapter and Android / iOS parity	1.0	Rs 1.0 lakh
Messaging: WhatsApp provider, SMS with DLT, opt-in, quiet hours	2.0	Rs 2.0 lakh
Analytics and ROI report; exports	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Advanced analytics and dashboards for chains	2.0	Rs 2.0 lakh
Multi-outlet and franchise hierarchy	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Referral engine	0.8	Rs 81,200
DPDP toolkit: notices, consent records, access and erasure, retention	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Platform console, support tools, audited impersonation	1.0	Rs 1.0 lakh
More operations tooling: health checks, alerts, admin automation	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
QA automation, load tests, security fixes	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Performance and scale engineering (for 1M+ members)	3.0	Rs 3.0 lakh
Localisation: Hindi, Gujarati, Marathi (A: Hindi + Gujarati)	0.8	Rs 81,200
Localisation: further regional languages	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Family / household accounts	1.0	Rs 1.0 lakh
Document and warranty vault	1.0	Rs 1.0 lakh
Brand-funded offers module	2.0	Rs 2.0 lakh
Enterprise pack: single sign-on, API, audit export, SLA tooling	2.5	Rs 2.5 lakh
Education module: student and parent profiles, parental consent	2.5	Rs 2.5 lakh
Venue-run prepaid packs (ledger only) and liability report	1.5	Rs 1.5 lakh
Security and audit readiness work (ISO 27001 / SOC 2 evidence)	2.0	Rs 2.0 lakh
Total shared platform work	**47.1**	**Rs 47.8 lakh**

Shared build: **Rs 47.8 lakh**. Business-type build and launch: **Rs 49.3 lakh** (next pages). Total build: **Rs 97.1 lakh**.

One-time costs, the wave order and the team

One-time item	Estimate
Company set-up and first compliance (incorporation, GST)	Rs 15,000
Agreements, DPA, privacy notice, programme terms (lawyer)	Rs 1,25,000
Written opinion on points vs prepaid rules and venue-run packs	Rs 1,00,000
Trademark search and filing (1 class)	Rs 30,000
DLT registration (SMS)	Rs 5,900
Apple Developer Program (first year)	Rs 8,700
Penetration test, web app + API	Rs 1,25,000
Cyber insurance, first year	Rs 80,000
Brand, pitch deck, sales kit, demo video (shared)	Rs 1,00,000
Demo devices, QR stands, printing	Rs 40,000
Additional trademark classes and logo marks	Rs 60,000
Second penetration test and yearly retest	Rs 1,25,000
ISO 27001 or SOC 2 audit and certification (year 2)	Rs 4,00,000
Partner programme kit: price lists, demo accounts, training	Rs 1,50,000
Brand refresh and website expansion	Rs 2,00,000
Statutory audit, ROC filings, tax returns (annual)	Rs 60,000
Recruitment fees for hires (about 8% of annual pay)	Rs 2,50,000
Laptops and equipment for hires	Rs 2,50,000
Per-business-type launch items (legal review, sales kit, training, pilot support, security review)	Rs 46,00,000
Total before contingency	**Rs 67,24,600**

Wave order

Wave	Business types	Quarters	Why in this order
WAVE 1	Cafes, QSR chains, sweets and bakeries, ice cream and dessert, salons, turfs and courts	Q1 to Q4	Fast sales cycle, simple rules, many already have a POS or booking tool.
WAVE 2	Clothing, sarees, footwear, mobile shops, fine dining, gyms, car wash, laundry, hotels, gaming, coaching, specialty shops	Q3 to Q6	Need family accounts, occasions, check-in and booking links.
WAVE 3	Supermarkets, electronics, kiranas, pharmacies, clinics, jewellery, schools, colleges, malls, channel loyalty, clubs	Q5 to Q8	Need integrations, security evidence, sector legal review or minors' data design.

> **Do not start Wave 3 types until Wave 1 pays for itself in support time.** Schools, clinics, jewellers and coalitions each need a legal opinion first. The costs here are for that opinion and for building, not for the sale.

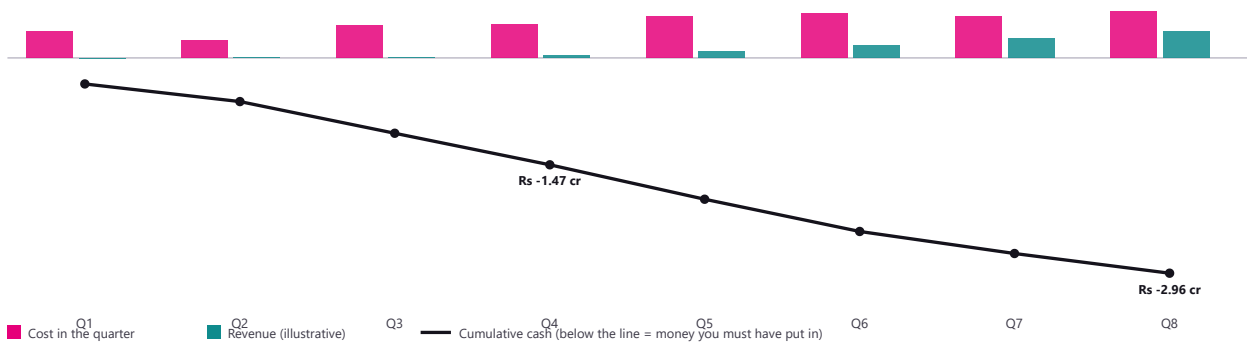
Team and run-rate in the last quarter

Line	Per month, Q5 to Q8
Cloud, tools, communications, security, legal and accounts (growth stage)	Rs 2,50,000
Support and customer success (about four people)	Rs 1,80,000
Sales team (about three people)	Rs 1,80,000
Product and operations head	Rs 1,20,000
Finance and compliance (part-time)	Rs 60,000
Marketing and partner events	Rs 1,50,000

Twenty-four months, quarter by quarter

Line	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q5	Q6	Q7	Q8	Total
Product build (partner team)	Rs 7.2 lakh	Rs 7.2 lakh	Rs 14.6 lakh	Rs 17.0 lakh	Rs 14.6 lakh	Rs 14.6 lakh	Rs 12.2 lakh	Rs 9.7 lakh	Rs 97.1 lakh
One-time legal, security, brand, launch	Rs 20.2 lakh	Rs 6.7 lakh	Rs 8.1 lakh	Rs 6.7 lakh	Rs 5.4 lakh	Rs 8.1 lakh	Rs 5.4 lakh	Rs 6.7 lakh	Rs 67.2 lakh
Running costs (cloud, tools, people, sales, upkeep)	Rs 3.8 lakh	Rs 7.4 lakh	Rs 16.2 lakh	Rs 16.2 lakh	Rs 28.2 lakh	Rs 28.2 lakh	Rs 28.2 lakh	Rs 34.3 lakh	Rs 1.63 cr
Partner commissions on revenue	Rs 1,215	Rs 5,265	Rs 19,688	Rs 47,812	Rs 1.4 lakh	Rs 2.5 lakh	Rs 3.9 lakh	Rs 5.5 lakh	Rs 14.1 lakh
Contingency (15%)	Rs 4.7 lakh	Rs 3.2 lakh	Rs 5.8 lakh	Rs 6.0 lakh	Rs 7.2 lakh	Rs 7.6 lakh	Rs 6.9 lakh	Rs 7.6 lakh	Rs 49.1 lakh
Total cost	**Rs 35.9 lakh**	**Rs 24.6 lakh**	**Rs 44.9 lakh**	**Rs 46.5 lakh**	**Rs 56.9 lakh**	**Rs 61.1 lakh**	**Rs 56.6 lakh**	**Rs 63.8 lakh**	**Rs 3.90 cr**
Revenue (illustrative)	Rs 8,100	Rs 35,100	Rs 1.3 lakh	Rs 3.2 lakh	Rs 9.4 lakh	Rs 16.8 lakh	Rs 26.2 lakh	Rs 36.8 lakh	Rs 94.2 lakh
Net for the quarter	Rs -35.8 lakh	Rs -24.2 lakh	Rs -43.6 lakh	Rs -43.3 lakh	Rs -47.4 lakh	Rs -44.3 lakh	Rs -30.3 lakh	Rs -27.1 lakh	**Rs -2.96 cr**
Cumulative cash	**Rs -35.8 lakh**	**Rs -60.0 lakh**	**Rs -1.04 cr**	**Rs -1.47 cr**	**Rs -1.94 cr**	**Rs -2.39 cr**	**Rs -2.69 cr**	**Rs -2.96 cr**	
Paying venues at quarter end (illustrative)	3	10	25	60	120	200	300	400	

Chart B3. Full programme: cost, revenue and cumulative cash by quarter



Reading it. You need about **Rs 2.96 cr** of funding at the deepest point, rounded to **Rs 3.00 cr**, with founders unpaid and revenue as illustrated. The run rate in the last quarter is about **Rs 21.3 lakh a month** against revenue of about **Rs 12.2 lakh a month**. That gap is the reason to stage-gate the spend (section 10).

6 / PER BUSINESS TYPE

Cost to launch each business type

What it costs to enter each type once the shared platform exists: a preset, any extra build and integration, a legal check, a sales kit, a training video, pilot support and (for chains and institutions) a security review. Build cost is at the partner rate.

1 Food and beverage

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Cafes, tea and coffee shops	0.3	Rs 30,450	Rs 15,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 1.1 lakh**
QSR and restaurant chains	1.8	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 15,000	Rs 80,000	**Rs 2.8 lakh**
Fine dining, bars and lounges	0.3	Rs 30,450	Rs 60,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 1.6 lakh**
Sweets, bakeries and namkeen	0.3	Rs 30,450	Rs 15,000	Rs 75,000	**Rs 1.2 lakh**
Ice cream, juice, dessert and cloud kitchens	0.3	Rs 30,450	Rs 15,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 1.1 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 7.7 lakh**

2 Fashion, lifestyle and gifting retail

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Clothing and boutique stores	1.3	Rs 1.3 lakh	Rs 15,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.1 lakh**
Saree shops and ethnic wear	1.1	Rs 1.1 lakh	Rs 50,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.3 lakh**
Jewellery	0.8	Rs 81,200	Rs 75,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.2 lakh**
Footwear, bags, accessories, gift shops	0.3	Rs 30,450	Rs 15,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 1.1 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 7.7 lakh**

3 Electronics, appliances and durables

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Electronics and appliance stores	3.3	Rs 3.3 lakh	Rs 1.4 lakh	Rs 90,000	**Rs 5.6 lakh**
Mobile and accessories shops	0.8	Rs 81,200	Rs 15,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 1.6 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 7.3 lakh**

4 Grocery, supermarkets and pharmacies

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Supermarkets and hypermarket chains	5.3	Rs 5.4 lakh	Rs 2.1 lakh	Rs 1.4 lakh	**Rs 8.9 lakh**
Kirana and neighbourhood stores	1.3	Rs 1.3 lakh	Rs 25,000	Rs 1.0 lakh	**Rs 2.6 lakh**
Pharmacies and wellness stores	1.8	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 75,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 3.2 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 14.7 lakh**

5 Health, beauty and wellness

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Salons, barbers, spas and nail studios	1.8	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 40,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.9 lakh**
Gyms, yoga and fitness studios	1.8	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 15,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.6 lakh**
Clinics, dental, diagnostics and optical	1.3	Rs 1.3 lakh	Rs 90,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.9 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 8.4 lakh**

6 Auto and home services

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Car wash, garages and two-wheeler service	0.8	Rs 81,200	Rs 20,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 1.7 lakh**
Laundry, dry cleaning, tailors and repair	0.6	Rs 60,900	Rs 15,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 1.4 lakh**
Pet shops, vets and grooming; florists; bookshops	0.3	Rs 30,450	Rs 15,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 1.1 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 4.2 lakh**

7 Hospitality, sport and entertainment

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Hotels, resorts and homestays	1.8	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 30,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.8 lakh**
Turf, pickleball, padel and badminton venues	1.8	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 25,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.7 lakh**
Gaming parlours, bowling, trampoline parks, cinemas	1.1	Rs 1.1 lakh	Rs 40,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.2 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 7.7 lakh**

8 Education

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Schools	1.8	Rs 1.8 lakh	Rs 3.0 lakh	Rs 1.2 lakh	**Rs 6.0 lakh**
Colleges and universities	2.8	Rs 2.8 lakh	Rs 2.5 lakh	Rs 1.2 lakh	**Rs 6.5 lakh**
Coaching, tuition, music, dance and hobby classes	0.8	Rs 81,200	Rs 50,000	Rs 65,000	**Rs 2.0 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 14.5 lakh**

9 Adjacent opportunities (later)

Business type	Build (person-months)	Build cost	Legal and security	Sales kit, training, pilot	Total
Malls, markets and city coalitions	6.3	Rs 6.4 lakh	Rs 3.5 lakh	Rs 1.3 lakh	**Rs 11.2 lakh**
Dealer and channel loyalty	5.3	Rs 5.4 lakh	Rs 3.0 lakh	Rs 65,000	**Rs 9.0 lakh**
Clubs, societies, trusts and event organisers	1.3	Rs 1.3 lakh	Rs 1.0 lakh	Rs 65,000	**Rs 3.0 lakh**
Subtotal					**Rs 23.2 lakh**

All 29 types: Rs 95.3 lakh (before contingency). Of this, legal and security reviews are about Rs 23.8 lakh; the rest is build and launch work.

6 / PER CUSTOMER

What each kind of customer costs us every month

Separate from the launch cost above: the ongoing cost of serving one customer, against a suggested price. From the Founder Playbook model (messaging, hosting share, support hours).

Example customer	Price / month	Our cost to serve	Gross margin
Cafe, 1 outlet	Rs 1,499	Rs 520	66%
Salon / spa, 1 outlet	Rs 1,999	Rs 520	74%
Boutique / saree shop	Rs 2,499	Rs 580	77%
Gym or sports venue	Rs 2,999	Rs 1,080	64%
Restaurant chain, 5 outlets	Rs 9,999	Rs 2,800	72%
School, 1 campus (about 1,000 parents)	Rs 15,000	Rs 3,120	79%
College, 5,000 students	Rs 40,000	Rs 8,680	78%
Supermarket chain, 20 stores	Rs 1,50,000	Rs 43,300	71%

Marketing messages are passed on at cost plus 30%. The platform cost excludes the venue's own marketing messages and any integration support, which is billed as setup.

Rule of thumb for pricing

- A venue must pay at least 3x its monthly cost to serve, or support time will erase the margin.
- Small venues only work if onboarding is self-serve. Spending a person-day on a Rs 1,499 plan loses money for the first year.
- Chains and institutions should pay setup fees that cover their integration and security work.

7 / DEVELOPMENT PARTNER

Working with your development company

A 20-year relationship helps, but the product, the code and the customer data are the company's most valuable assets, so the paper must be as clear as with a stranger.

Suggested payment structure (fixed-scope packages)

Milestone	Share of package	Condition
Start	15%	Signed scope, person-month estimate, schedule, IP assignment, NDA
Design and architecture sign-off	20%	Written design for the package reviewed by you or an independent reviewer
Working beta in a pilot venue	30%	Demo on a real phone and counter, with test results
Production acceptance	25%	Acceptance tests pass; security fixes closed; documentation delivered
Warranty holdback	10%	Paid 60 days after go-live if no serious defects

Alternative: time-and-materials with a monthly cap, weekly demos and a written burn report. Use this for the exploratory work (integrations) and fixed-scope for the well-defined work (billing, rules, scanner).

PUT IN THE CONTRACT

- All code and designs assigned to the company; code lives in the company's own GitHub organisation from day one
- No partner-owned libraries without an open licence; list of third-party components
- Security duties: no secrets in code, access by named people, breach notice within hours
- Data ownership: member data belongs to the venue; partner is a sub-processor with a data-processing agreement
- Support terms after go-live: response times, upkeep retainer, warranty
- Non-solicit and confidentiality; key-person cover so one engineer leaving does not stop delivery

CONTROLS ON YOUR SIDE

- One internal owner who accepts or rejects each package
- Weekly demo; monthly budget review against this plan
- Independent code review once per quarter (a few person-days, about Rs 40,000 to 80,000)
- Change requests priced in person-months before work starts
- Keep the build and deployment accounts in the company's name, not the partner's
- Do not pre-pay beyond the milestone table

If the partner offers equity or revenue share instead of cash: treat it as a separate legal decision with its own lawyer. It lowers early cash but gives a third party a claim on the company, and it changes who decides the roadmap.

8 / WHAT IF IT GOES SLOWER

Sensitivity: how the money needed changes

What if	Standard (3 types, 12 months): money to put in	Full programme (24 months): money to put in
Base case (partner rate, plan as stated)	Rs 46.8 lakh	Rs 2.96 cr
Development at market rate instead of partner rate	Rs 54.7 lakh	Rs 3.38 cr
Revenue one quarter late	Rs 47.7 lakh	Rs 3.26 cr
Half as many venues as planned	Rs 47.7 lakh	Rs 3.36 cr
Market rate and half the venues together	Rs 55.6 lakh	Rs 3.78 cr

"Money to put in" is the deepest point of cumulative cash. It rises when development costs more or revenue arrives later.

Levers that matter most

Lever	Effect
Development rate	Standard build is Rs 16.1 lakh at partner rate and Rs 21.9 lakh at market rate, a difference of Rs 5.8 lakh. For the full programme the difference is Rs 34.7 lakh.
Build only what a paying customer asked for	Wave 3 and the enterprise modules can wait. Cutting the full programme to Waves 1 and 2 lowers the build line by roughly a third.
Self-serve onboarding	Cuts support cost and lets the same team serve many more small venues.
Price	Raising the average from Rs 1,800 to Rs 2,500 changes revenue by 39% for the same venues.
Partner-led sales	Commissions cost 15% of revenue but replace a sales hire you would pay for regardless of results.
Founders' pay	Not included. Two founders at Rs 60,000 each add Rs 14.4 lakh a year.

9 / COSTS PEOPLE FORGET

What you and I might miss

Item	Rough size	Why it appears
Founders' own pay	Rs 1.2 lakh a month for two at Rs 60,000	Not in the plan. Without it, founders fund the plan with their time.
Scope growth on fixed-price work	10 to 20% of build	Requirements change once real cafes use it. Held partly in the contingency.
Statutory audit, ROC filings, tax returns	Rs 40,000 to 80,000 a year (estimate)	A private limited company must file every year.
GST cash timing	18% collected, paid later	Output GST is a pass-through, but late payment attracts interest. Keep it in a separate account.
Employer costs on staff	About 13 to 15% on pay for PF, ESI, gratuity where applicable (confirm with CA)	Support, sales and finance monthly figures in this plan are treated as loaded; check.
Recruitment and equipment	Included in Full programme	About 8% of annual pay per hire; laptops and phones.
Payment gateway fees on our own subscriptions	About 2% of revenue (estimate)	Small, but it adds up at scale. UPI autopay is often cheaper than cards.
Free months and pilot discounts	2 months free x pilot venues	Pilot support is costed; the foregone revenue is not.
Churn and bad debt	3 to 5% of revenue (assumption)	Small venues close or stop paying.
Dollar and platform price changes	3 to 8% a year	Cloud, Apple and tool prices are in dollars; Meta changes WhatsApp rates up to four times a year.
Data-breach reserve	Rs 5 to 10 lakh set aside	Insurance has a deductible; legal, forensics and notices come first.
Legal disputes reserve	Rs 2 to 5 lakh	Points disputes, venue exits, partner disagreements.
Office or co-working	Rs 0 to 1.5 lakh a month	Not in the plan; remote work assumed.
Travel and installation visits	Rs 30,000 to 60,000 a month at scale	Installing and training at venues in person.
Translation and local-language support	Part of localisation build; plus content refresh	Regional language help videos and cheat sheets per sector.
Source-code escrow and documentation	A few person-days per package	So the product can survive a change of partner.
Insurance renewals	Yearly	Cyber and professional indemnity renew every year.
Wallet-platform risk	Cost of rebuilding an engine	Google, Apple or PassKit can change terms. Keep the adapter design.
Key-person risk	One senior engineer at the partner	Negotiate a named backup and written documentation.
Founder time	The largest hidden cost	Sales, pilots, support and partner management take full days.

10 / CONTROL

Release the money in tranches

Do not commit the whole amount at once. Tie each tranche to a result that proves the next one is safe.

Standard (3 types, 12 months)

Tranche	Net cash needed	Release when
Tranche 1 (Q1 to Q2)	Rs 33.8 lakh	Legal base done; build packages accepted; first 3 pilot venues live
Tranche 2 (Q3 to Q4)	Rs 13.0 lakh	Repeat visits up in at least 2 of 3 pilot types; 10+ venues willing to pay; support under about 1 hour per venue a month

Full programme (24 months)

Tranche	Net cash needed	Release when
Tranche 1 (Q1 to Q2)	Rs 60.0 lakh	Same as Standard Tranche 1
Tranche 2 (Q3 to Q4)	Rs 86.9 lakh	25+ paying venues; billing and messaging live; integrations wave 1 working
Tranche 3 (Q5 to Q6)	Rs 91.7 lakh	100+ paying venues; support time stable; first chain or institution signed; penetration test clean
Tranche 4 (Q7 to Q8)	Rs 57.4 lakh	Partner channel producing leads; unit economics proven; legal opinions in hand for each Wave 3 type

If money is short: what to cut first

Order	Cut or delay	Saves (approx.)
1	Wave 3 business types and enterprise modules	About one third of the full build
2	Education module and coalition / channel products	Rs 6.6 lakh of build, plus legal reviews
3	ISO 27001 or SOC 2 audit	Rs 4 lakh
4	Sales hires: use partner commissions instead	Rs 1.8 lakh a month at full size
5	Apple Wallet (use web card for iPhone)	Rs 8,700 a year plus about Rs 1.0 lakh
6	Paid WhatsApp and SMS (use free links)	The messaging build and registrations

Never cut

- Consent, privacy notice and venue data-processing agreement
- A penetration test before the first large customer
- The ledger, backups and a tested restore
- The written view on points versus prepaid rules before any venue-run pack
- IP assignment and company-owned code and accounts

Decisions for the founders

1. Start with Lean, Standard, or both in sequence (recommended: Lean for 60 days, then Standard if the repeat-visit test passes)
2. The partner company's real rate and the written estimate for the packages
3. Which three business types, and the three pilot venues
4. Where the Rs 47.0 lakh comes from (savings, investors, agency profits, partner equity) and who signs the budget each month
5. Whether founders take pay, and from when

NOTES

Where the numbers come from

Unit costs and prices (WhatsApp rates, SMS, DLT, Apple fee, Supabase and Vercel, salaries, incorporation) come from the sources listed in the Founder Playbook, which are third-party pages and should be re-checked before spending. The partner rate, uplift, commission, venue counts, prices and the reserves in section 9 are our assumptions. The model is in `output/playbook-src/budget_model.py`; change a value there and rebuild with `python budget_build.py` to refresh every table and chart.

Standard and Full budgets include a 15% contingency. Revenue is illustrative. This document is a planning tool, not financial or legal advice; confirm tax and legal points with a chartered accountant and a lawyer.